

Administrative Science Quarterly

Journal indexing and metrics

ASQ Guidance for AI Use for Authors and Reviewers

ASQ Guidance for Authors' Use of AI

Generative AI marks a turning point in scholarly production, offering the ability to streamline not only the technical mechanics of our craft but also the intellectual labor of inquiry itself. Based on our conversations with many scholars, the ways in which people are incorporating generative AI tools to facilitate their research are many, all-encompassing, and changing rapidly. Like statistical software and word processing before it, generative AI is a tool that has the potential to transform the research process and produce better output. But when generative AI is used without thoughtful oversight and deep engagement by authors, our scholarship suffers. We worry about a future in which AI assistance makes it ever easier for authors to churn out work that does not meet the field's standards. Our goal is to give our community a grounded sense of what appropriate uses are

In our view, appropriate uses include making programming and analysis more efficient, copy editing and improving readability, and finding the best sources to inform your theory and methods. But taken too far, each of these can lead to what we regard as bad research. Having AI refine and debug your code might be valuable, while having it take your data, generate a script to analyze it, and produce a table based on the most significant effects it finds cedes analytical control. Leveraging AI to code textual data in accordance with a deductively derived set of categories may make sense, but relying on it to analyze and interpret qualitative data inductively or abductively undermines critical processes of theorizing. Using AI to refine your argument to be less repetitive can strengthen your writing, but letting it develop entire arguments and write paragraphs for you abdicates authorship. And prompting AI to identify important works in a given area can be a helpful starting point for a literature review, but asking it to generate the review and synthesize key themes substitutes automated output for scholarly judgment. In each instance, the former supports high-quality scholarship, while the latter displaces the judgment and intellectual labor that make research credible.

The hardest things that we do in our research are also the most critical ones to get right. While generative AI may seem as though it can make these difficult tasks easier, we advise caution. Careful thinking and writing are essential for producing excellent scholarship. When human researchers encounter something we don't know, we engage in inquiry; when generative AI encounters something it doesn't know, it engages in

fabrication. By inviting productive frictions in your use of AI, you not only preserve your authorial voice but also maintain accountability for your scholarly output.

Of course, you are always accountable for everything that goes into a manuscript that you submit to *ASQ*. Authors, not tools, are responsible for the originality, accuracy, and integrity of all statements and should independently check any claims and analyses supported or assisted by AI. In the submission process, we now ask you to disclose AI use since knowing about it could help readers understand how your research was produced.

We want to publish your research, and we can do so only if it is thoughtful, high-quality work. We review your papers carefully and are deliberate about providing thoughtful, developmental feedback. We recognize the opportunity that new tools provide us to do better research. But we must not let the tools supplant our own ability as researchers to read, think, analyze, or develop insights. At its core, these are the essence of rigorous scholarship.

ASQ Guidance for Reviewers' Use of AI

We have a similar perspective on reviewers' use of AI. When you accept a handling editor's invitation to review a submission, you accept the responsibility to read the manuscript and engage in the important work of sharing your thoughts about it. You may use AI tools to improve the language or structure of the review you create. You may not use AI tools to read and summarize the article for you or to generate feedback.

Uploading a submitted manuscript into AI tools creates confidentiality risks and copyright issues. For this reason, both Cornell University (ASQ's owner) and Sage (ASQ's publishing partner) prohibit this use of AI, and we follow this policy. Never feed another scholar's unpublished work into a tool that could use that content in its future outputs to other users.

If you use an AI tool to improve your review's language or structure, you must read the output carefully before you submit it; you are responsible for the review's content. If an AI tool introduces errors, such as fake citations, you must catch and correct them.

If an ASQ editor believes that you have used AI to create any portion of your review we reserve the right not to use your review and to ask for an explanation. Depending on your response, we also reserve the right to mark you as an ineligible reviewer in our ScholarOne system.

If, as a reviewer, you have concerns about the use of AI in a manuscript you are reviewing, please share those concerns with the handling editor and, as appropriate, with the author. We do not expect you to always have a definitive response if an author acknowledges the use of AI in their manuscript. If you are not sure whether an author's disclosed use has compromised the quality of the submission, note your thoughts in your comments to the handling editor and/or comments to the author. If you are not confident about the quality of parts of the manuscript that were assisted by AI, say so; the handling editor will take that

feedback into consideration. Similarly, if you suspect undisclosed use of AI in a submission and are concerned about that, please raise your concerns with the handling editor either in your review or in an email.

We are all actively learning how AI changes the tasks we do, including reviewing manuscripts. By sharing with the handling editor and/or author what prompted your reaction (whether positive or negative) to aspects of the research assisted by AI, your input will add to our collective learning over time.

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